[68] This was clarified at the time of the premiere of *Desabhakta Chidambaranar*, a biographical play on VOC produced by Avvai T.K. Shanmugam (*Kalki*, 4-9-1960). K. Sadagopan, sub-editor of *Hindustan* weekly, recalled Rajaji saying at a public meeting that he had contributed a thousand rupees to SSNCo. Sadagopan, *Arasiyal Gnapagangal*, p. 27. On the occasion of the launch of *V.O. Chidambaram* in February 1949 Rajaji recalled that VOC had once stayed in his modest home: this may have been when VOC was travelling in Salem canvassing for shares. This information is missing in *Rajaji's Speeches*, pp. 7–8 but is found in the Tamil translation provided in Sivagnanam, *Enathu Porattam*, pp. 149–51.

[69] *Swadesamitran*, 31-3-1908; *The Hindu*, 1-4-1908.

[70] Periyar's talk on the occasion of a reading hall named after VOC in Chetpet, Madras, *Viduthalai*, 11-11-1948.

[71] Letter from SSNCo's Colombo agent Thumbayya to VOC, dated Colombo, 28-9-1908; *Swadesamitran*, 20-4-1909.

[72] Prospectus published in *Vivekabhanu*, 5 (8–11), August–November 1906.

[73] See *India*, 8-12-1906, for instance, and many subsequent issues. Also see *The Hindu*, 6-9-1907.

[74] VOC to M.N. Gonsalves, Colombo, dated Tuticorin, 5-11-1906. The letter is badly damaged. The information on cattle shipping comes from Eric Chapman's evidence in the sedition case against VOC, IOL: L/P&J/6/857.

[75] IOL: L/P&J/6/857.

[76] IOL: L/P&J/6/857.

[77] Guruswami Aiyar had no financial interests in the company and claimed that he did not even take any fees in any form. When repeatedly asked why he did not subscribe to the company he said it was 'my own wish'! T&TD, pp. 5, 17.

[78] MPAI, 1906, para 425.

[79] Parali S. Shanmugasundaram, 'Thaithirunadum Tharaka Mantiramum', *Lokopakari*, 29-11-1947.

[80] *The Hindu*, 6-9-1907.

[81] MPAI, 1906, para 505. For another report on this meeting, see *Vivekabhanu*, 5 (8–11), August–November 1906.

[82] MPAI, 1906, para 534.